

Vibe Coding: A Universal Prompting Framework

A field-agnostic guide that teaches anyone to instruct an AI to build things using clear, testable specifications.

1. What is vibe coding?

Vibe coding is the practice of shaping an AI's behavior by giving it a precise specification that sets intent, boundaries, sequence, and quality bars. The objective is to reduce ambiguity so that the AI can reliably deliver what you want with repeatable quality.

Why it matters: Reduces rework and improves reliability by eliminating ambiguity.

2. The core sections every prompt specification should include

2.1 Goal

- One sentence stating the single outcome you want
- Short paragraph defining scope boundaries (what's in/out)

2.2 Context

- Minimal setting the AI needs to interpret the task
- Prior decisions that must be honored

2.3 Inputs

- Exact inputs the AI receives with clear names
- Input limits (file size, count, etc.)
- Source of truth for each input

2.4 Assumptions

- Conditions you believe to be true (keep verifiable)

- Default behaviors when information is missing

2.5 Constraints

- Unbreakable rules (security, privacy, budget, size limits)
- Formatting requirements for outputs
- Conflict resolution priority order

2.6 Deliverables

- Checklist of artifacts to produce with names and locations
- Expected structure and format for each

2.7 Acceptance checks

- Machine verifiable tests (size limits, schema validity, etc.)
- Brief human review criteria (clarity, coherence)

2.8 Non-goals and out of scope

- Items explicitly not requested
- Adjacent tasks requiring approval

2.9 Versioning

- Simple identifier (v1.2) with date
- Short change log
- Compatibility notes

3. Optional sections (use only when needed)

- **Risks and mitigations:** Foreseeable risks with short mitigations
- **Error handling:** Response to validation failures with retry limits
- **Security redlines:** Company policies that must be enforced
- **Review and handoff:** Who reviews what and required attachments

4. How to write specifications the AI will follow

Structure:

- Use imperative voice and short sentences
- Numbered lists for sequences

- Place non-negotiable rules early under constraints

Clarity:

- Prefer concrete numbers over adjectives
- State allowed output formats
- Say to omit rather than invent when unknown

Conflict handling:

- Provide priority order (security → constraints → output → correctness → brevity)
- Define which source wins when inputs conflict

5. Self-check questions

- Can someone decide if the task is done by reading only deliverables and acceptance checks?
- Can any adjectives be replaced with numbers?
- Are non-goals explicit enough to prevent scope creep?

6. Model guidance

Every model family has different strengths. Treat model choice as experimental. When results drift, revisit assumptions, constraints, and acceptance checks before changing anything else.

7. Key principles

- The best specifications are short, literal, and testable
- Add optional sections only when they directly improve success
- Keep specifications living documents with version updates
- Use vibe coding to make AI predictable, safe, and useful without examples

Quick reference: Goal → Context → Inputs → Assumptions → Constraints → Deliverables → Acceptance checks → Non-goals → Version